

Rudger H. Dame

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EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist | Carvana | Oct 2023 – Apr 2026

Tempe, AZ

- Developed and productionized a multitarget TensorFlow model to predict both vehicle kick probability and associated loss amount, strengthening acquisition risk controls and significantly reducing financial exposure from auction returns by ~10-15%.
- Built an inventory churn model (LightGBM) forecasting 7-day sell-through probability trained leveraging dynamic website behavioral data, enabling data-driven inventory and informing marketing strategies.
- Owned end-to-end production monitoring and model governance for kick and churn models by building, maintaining, and reporting to non-technical stakeholders with production dashboards; executed A/B tests on new features to significantly improve model robustness and reliability.

Lead Data Scientist | New Reach Education | Aug 2022 – Sept 2023

Tempe, AZ

- Mentored team members on analytical best practices while building custom CRM integrations and real-time sales dashboards.
- Led the design and deployment of logistic regression-based lead qualification models, eliminating 20–40% of low-quality meetings and boosting top salesperson conversion rates by 2–3x.
- Managed the migration of all company data assets on Google Sheets to Snowflake, enabling and building scalable analytics and self-service reporting via Tableau and ThoughtSpot.

Research Scientist/Teaching Assistant | Baylor University | Aug 2019 – May 2022

Waco, TX

- Led the analysis of geospatial and remote sensing data to develop a narrative for the geological history of Venus and identify future research challenges and opportunities. Built advanced analytical tools and machine learning models in Python to produce geological and statistical insights from planetary datasets.
- Taught two undergraduate geology and environmental science courses per semester for two years, effectively communicating complex technical concepts and instructing students in MATLAB.

JPL NASA Research Intern | Jet Propulsion Laboratory | Summer 2020 and 2021

Pasadena, CA

- Utilized extensive geological datasets from Earth and Venus to extract metrics from Earth subduction zones and identify potential subduction zones on Venus.
- Developed MATLAB models incorporating synthetic gravity, Fourier analysis, and particle swarm optimization, delivering groundbreaking evidence in favor of subduction on Venus; presented findings at AGU 2020 and JPL 2021 conferences.

Geology Research Assistant | Brigham Young University | Nov 2017 - Apr 2019

Provo, UT

- Performed statistical and geospatial analysis of 3D terrain and radar data to quantify surface roughness, generating insights applicable to planetary surface modeling.
- Presented findings on the formation of smooth terrains on celestial bodies like Mars and Titan at the European Planetary Science Congress 2018, showcasing effective communication and interdisciplinary collaboration skills.

EDUCATION

Baylor University, *Master of Science in Geophysics*

Thesis: Gravitational Indications of Subduction on Venus

Brigham Young University, *Bachelor of Science in Applied Physics*

LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Machine Learning: NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Scikit-learn, LightGBM, Tensorflow, Keras, GeoPandas, NLTK, and Jupyter Notebooks

Data Engineering / MLOps: Snowflake, AWS (Lambda, S3, EC2), GCP, Cron, dbt, A/B Testing, Conda, GitHub

Languages: Python, SQL, MATLAB

Visualization: Tableau, Streamlit, ThoughtSpot, Power BI